

Skills

Preparing Injections from an Ampule

Checklist

Checklist

S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified the health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene and prepared supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Prepared the medications:	☐	☐	☐	
1. When using a medication cart, moved it outside the patient's room. Unlocked the cart.				
2. When using an automated medication dispensing system, logged on to the unit.				
3. Followed the agency's "No Interruption Zone" policy; prepared medications for one patient at a time.				
4. Selected the ampule containing the correct drug from the medication cart or automated dispensing system. Compared the label of the medication with the MAR.				
5. Ensured the rights of medication safety: right medication, right dose, right time, right route, right patient, and right documentation.				
6. Calculated the drug dose as necessary. Double-checked calculation.				
Prepared the ampule:	☐	☐	☐	
1. Tapped the top of the ampule lightly and quickly.				
2. Placed a sterile gauze pad or disposable ampule breaker around the neck of the ampule.				
3. Quickly and firmly snapped the neck of the ampule.				
4. Set ampule on a flat surface.				
5. Obtained the correct size syringe and a filter needle.				
6. Drew up the medication:				
1. Attached a filter needle or filter straw to the appropriate sized syringe.				
2. Withdrew medication by inverting ampule and placing filter needle tip in liquid without touching the rim of the ampule OR by tipping ampule and placing filter needle in liquid without touching the rim. Repositioned ampule so that needle tip remained in the liquid.				
3. Drew up the medication quickly, kept the needle tip under the surface of the liquid. Tipped the ampule to bring all of the fluid within reach of the needle.				
4. If air bubbles were aspirated, did not expel the air into the ampule.				
5. To expel excess air bubbles, removed the needle from the ampule. Tapped the side of the syringe. Drew the				

plunger back slightly, and pushed the plunger upward to eject the air. Did not eject the fluid.

6. When the syringe contained excess fluid, discarded it using the appropriate medication waste receptacle per the organization's practice. Slowly ejected the excess into the medical waste receptacle. Rechecked the fluid level in the syringe.
7. Carefully covered the filter needle with its safety sheath, and removed it from the syringe.
8. Replaced the filter needle with a regular safety needle of the appropriate gauge and length for the injection. Discarded the filter needle in the appropriate sharps container.

Asked another nurse to verify the medication per the organization's practice.

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When medication was drawn up away from the patient's bedside, labeled the syringe with the name of the medication and the amount of medication it contained.

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Disposed of soiled supplies. Placed the broken ampule and used filter needle or straw in the appropriate waste receptacle. Cleaned work area, and performed hand hygiene.

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Documented the procedure in the patient's record.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____